

Honor in literature evangelism

1. Meaning of Literature Evangelism

Literature evangelism is the ministry of spreading the gospel through printed materials such as books, magazines, tracts, and pamphlets. It involves prayerfully sharing Christian literature to lead people to Christ, strengthen faith, and teach biblical truth. Those who engage in this ministry are often called colporteurs or literature evangelists.

2. Importance of Literature in Leading People to Christ (Bible & Ellen G. White – Summary)

Literature has always played an important role in God's work of reaching people. In the Bible, God commanded His words to be written so that future generations could read, remember, and obey them (Deuteronomy 6:6–9; Habakkuk 2:2). The written Word allows the message of salvation to go where the preacher cannot go. Books and letters written by prophets and apostles, such as Paul's epistles, continue to preach long after the writer is gone.

Ellen G. White strongly emphasized literature evangelism as a powerful means of evangelism. She taught that books and papers are “silent messengers” that enter homes and reach hearts that might otherwise be closed to direct preaching. Literature can awaken interest, answer questions, correct error, and point people to Christ in a quiet and non-threatening way.

She also explained that literature evangelism prepares the way for greater gospel work. A person may read a book many times, reflect on it, and eventually make a decision for Christ. Literature can reach all classes of people—the rich, the poor, the educated, and the uneducated. It is especially effective in places where public preaching is limited or restricted.

According to Ellen G. White, those who sell or distribute Christian literature are doing sacred work. They are missionaries, cooperating with angels and the Holy Spirit. Literature evangelism is not only about selling books but about saving souls. When carried out with prayer, humility, and love, it becomes one of the most effective tools for spreading the everlasting gospel.

3. Essential Qualifications of a Colporteur

A colporteur should have:

1. A strong Christian character and love for Christ
2. Faith in God and commitment to prayer
3. Honesty and integrity in all dealings
4. Courage and perseverance
5. Courtesy, patience, and good communication skills

4. How the Colporteur Is Supported

A colporteur is usually supported through:

Commissions from the sale of books and magazines

Support or sponsorship from the church or conference

Faith in God's provision as they work diligently

5. Steps in the Sale of a Book or Magazine

1. Approach politely and respectfully
2. Create interest in the literature
3. Present the value and purpose of the book

4. Close the sale courteously and thank the customer

6. How to Arouse Interest in Purchasing Literature

Interest can be aroused by:

Asking questions related to the person's needs

Sharing a short, meaningful message from the book

Explaining how the literature can help spiritually or practically

Showing enthusiasm and confidence

7. Meeting Objections to Purchasing Literature

When objections arise, a colporteur should:

Listen patiently and respectfully

Answer kindly without arguing

Emphasize the value rather than the price

Trust God and accept rejection politely

8. Practical Projects in Literature Evangelism

A Pathfinder may fulfill this honor by doing one of the following:

Maintaining a literature rack and keeping records

Distributing literature house-to-house or by mail

Selling Seventh-day Adventist books or magazines

Supplying religious books to officials, hospitals, or nursing homes

Providing magazine subscriptions as gifts

Sending literature to mission fields

9. Conclusion

Literature evangelism is a vital part of God's work. Through printed materials, the gospel reaches homes, hearts, and nations. Every Pathfinder who participates in this ministry becomes a messenger of hope, helping to prepare the world for the soon return of Jesus Christ.